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Authorisation and authentication

Creating login pages 60m

The first step in the authentication process is to create a login page. This login page will contain a login form.



```
1 <form method= "POST " action= "login.php ">
2 <h1>Customer Login</h1>
3 <label for= "username ">User name: </label>
4 <input type= "email " id= "username " size= "30 " name= "username " required
5 >
6 <p>
7 <label for= "password ">Password: </label>
8 <input type= "password " id= "password " size= "15 " name= "password " min=
9 "10 " max= "30 " required>
10 </p>
11 <input type = "submit " name= "submit " value= "Login ">
12 </form>
```



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Note that this form will post to the same PHP page. This would still work if the 'action' was empty or missing, but it is more secure to explicitly define the action, even if it is posting to the same page.

When the POST request from the form is processed, the user record needs to be retrieved from the user table using the email, and then the passwords need to be compared. Since the password in the database is encrypted, and the password that will be sent in the POST request will be in plain text, they need to be compared using the **password_verify** function:

```
password_verify($password, $hashpassword))
```

The first argument to this is the plain-text password; the second is the encrypted version.

Here is the code that retrieves the relevant record from the database and then checks the password.



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```
1 // Validate credentials with username and password
2 if(empty($username_err) && empty($password_err)){
3 // Prepare a select statement
4 $sql = "SELECT id, user_name, password FROM users WHERE user_name = ? ";
5
6 if($stmt = mysqli_prepare($link, $sql)){
7 // Bind variables to the prepared statement as parameters
8 mysqli_stmt_bind_param($stmt, "s ", $param_username);
9
10 // Set parameters for username
11 $param_username = $username;
12
13 // Attempt to execute the prepared statement
14 if(mysqli_stmt_execute($stmt)){
15 // Store result
16 mysqli_stmt_store_result($stmt);
17
18 // Check if username exists, if yes then verify password
19 if(mysqli_stmt_num_rows($stmt) == 1){
20 // Bind result variables. Use hashed password for encryption and save in the
    database.
21
22 mysqli_stmt_bind_result($stmt, $id, $user_name, $hashed_password);
23 if(mysqli_stmt_fetch($stmt)){
24 if(password_verify($password, $hashed_password)){
25 // Password is correct, so start a new session
26 session_start();
```



The code that has been provided so far can compare the username (email address) and password of a user against the database.

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However, although the example above shows the user a message stating, 'Congratulations, you are logged in!', no meaningful logging-in process has yet taken place. For that, some way of recognising that the member is in a logged-in state is required. The solution to this problem is to use sessions.



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In the activity below, you will create a login page for the admin panel you created for the web page that will showcase your projects.

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If you need a refresher about this, we recommend taking a look at the following page:

Practice activity create an admin panel for your portfolio →



☒ Create a login page

Non-Assessed

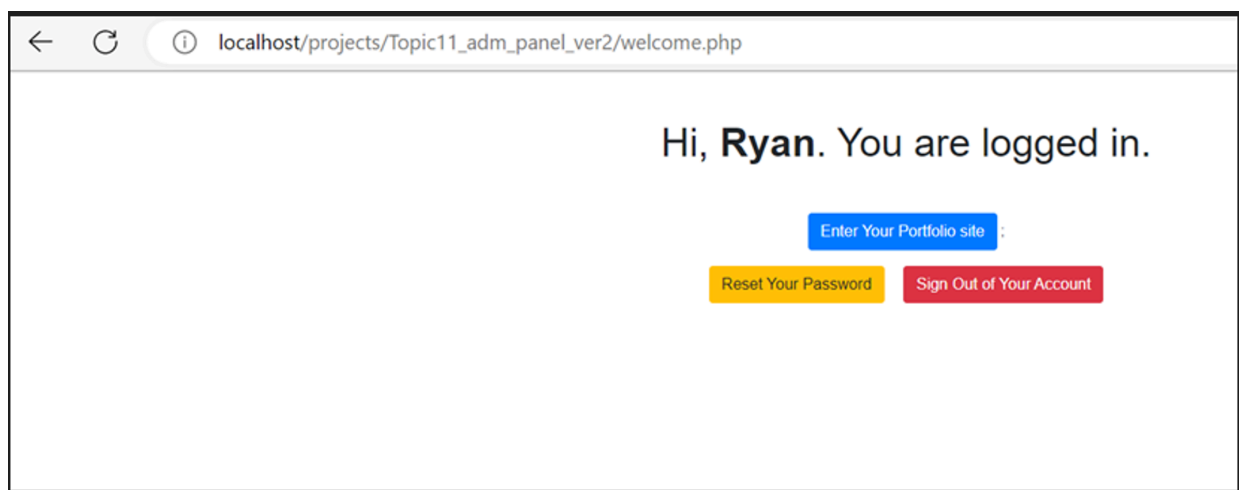
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In this activity, you will create a login page for the admin panel you developed in a previous activity. The admin panel you developed was for your portfolio, the web page showcasing the projects you've created for potential employers to view.

Create the login page for this admin panel using the content we've learnt so far. The code you write to create this login page should help the user (in this case, you) log in and direct them to the admin panel.

Please note that since we haven't yet covered sessions, your login page will not successfully log in a user. You will instead have to create a message that is displayed to users to indicate to them that they have logged in and completed the login process.

See below for an example of how the login page should appear to users.



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☐ I've completed this activity

Submit

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Thoughts on this page?

